

record at Hollywood last year.

At New Orleans, where Andy Cohen is laboring through a most vexing season, Hancken can find several prospects. "Actually, New Orleans has a better team than last year outside the box," he said. "They just don't have any pitching." The one hurler there of note is an old Waco favorite, Don Kildoo, who must be rated a major league hopeful. The other Pels on the way up are outfielders Emil Panko and John Powers, third baseman Vern Piver and shortstop Dick Birone.

Hancken's selection of Powers came as a surprise.

"He's improved so much," Buddy explained. "He looks every inch like a big league player this year. His defense is a lot better, his throwing has greatly improved, he's laying off the bad pitches and he's still hitting homers. You have to give him a good chance now." Powers is hitting .315 and has 10 homers.

Actually, the former Waco home run king gave evidence here this spring that he is ready for promotions. Batting against Pittsburgh's Friend, he hit three consecutive homers over the Katy Park fence.

Birone is another Mazerowski in the infield. Piver made the jump from Class C to New Orleans after a .346 year in 1955 with Salinas in the California League.

There are a number of other players of note on down the line, of course, such as Williamsport's